# STATE LEGISLATURE

**ARTICLES 168-212: ONE MANDATORY → ARTICLE 169 CREATION OR → ASSEMBLY AND COUNCIL COMPOSITION → SESSIONS, OFFICERS, QUORUM AND → PRESIDING OFFICER NEUTRALITY AND → PRIVILEGES, ACCOUNTABILITY DEVICES AND**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◐ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g5 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

## 00 STAGE 00 — ARTICLES 168-212: ONE MANDATORY HOUSE, ONE OPTIONAL HOUSE

ARTICLES 168-212 · ONE MANDATORY HOUSE, ONE OPTIONAL HOUSE · STATE LEGISLATURE UNDER ARTICLE 168 · GOVERNOR + ASSEMBLY IN EVERY STATE · GOVERNOR + ASSEMBLY + COUNCIL IN SIX BICAMERAL STATES. · SIX COUNCIL STATES · ANDHRA PRADESH · UTTAR PRADESH

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- STATE LEGISLATURE UNDER ARTICLE 168
- Governor + Assembly in every State
- Governor + Assembly + Council in six bicameral States.

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- SIX COUNCIL STATES
- Andhra Pradesh
- Uttar Pradesh

### CHECK / LIMIT

- CONSTITUTIONAL RAIL
- 168-177 design/membership/sessions → 178-195 officers/privilege
- 196-207 Bills/finance → 208-212 procedure and judicial restraint.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CORE: Assembly has direct mandate and confidence; Council offers optional delay and continuity.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CORE: Assembly has direct mandate and confidence; Council offers optional delay and continuity.**

## 01 STAGE 01 — ARTICLE 169 CREATION OR ABOLITION ROUTE

ARTICLE 169 CREATION OR ABOLITION ROUTE · STATE ASSEMBLY RESOLUTION MAJORITY OF TOTAL MEMBERSHIP + AT · PARLIAMENT MAY ENACT ORDINARY LAW SIMPLE MAJORITY · INCIDENTAL CONSTITUTIONAL TEXT CHANGES · NOT ARTICLE 368 AMENDMENT · COUNCIL CREATED OR ABOLISHED · RESOLUTION DOES NOT ITSELF CREATE A COUNCIL AND DOES

STATE ASSEMBLY RESOLUTION majority of total membership + at least two-thirds present and voting → PARLIAMENT MAY ENACT ORDINARY LAW simple majority → incidental constitutional text changes → not Article 368 amendment → COUNCIL CREATED OR ABOLISHED

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- STATE ASSEMBLY RESOLUTION majority of total membership + at least two-thirds present and voting
- PARLIAMENT MAY ENACT ORDINARY LAW simple majority

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- incidental constitutional text changes
- not Article 368 amendment

### CHECK / LIMIT

- COUNCIL CREATED OR ABOLISHED
- Resolution does not itself create a Council and does not compel Parliament to legislate.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- STATE ASSEMBLY RESOLUTION majority of total membership + at least two-thirds present and voting
- PARLIAMENT MAY ENACT ORDINARY LAW simple majority

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Resolution does not itself create a Council and does not compel Parliament to legislate.**

## 02 STAGE 02 — ASSEMBLY AND COUNCIL COMPOSITION, DURATION AND MEMBERSHIP

ASSEMBLY AND COUNCIL COMPOSITION, DURATION AND MEMBERSHIP · ARTICLE 170 · DIRECT TERRITORIAL ELECTION · NORMAL 60-500 WITH EXCEPTIONS AGE 25 · FIVE YEARS UNLESS SOONER DISSOLVED · CONFIDENCE CHAMBER. · ARTICLE 171 · <= ONE-THIRD ASSEMBLY; ORDINARILY ~40

| Article 171 | <= one-third Assembly; ordinarily ~40 | permanent | age 30 |
|---|---|---|---|
| STV for elected streams | one-third retire every two years | six-year member term. | |

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Article 170
- direct territorial election
- normal 60-500 with exceptions age 25
- five years unless sooner dissolved
- confidence chamber.

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 171
- <= one-third Assembly; ordinarily ~40
- age 30
- 1/3 local bodies
- 1/12 graduates

### CHECK / LIMIT

- 1/12 teachers
- 1/3 MLAs
- 1/6 nominated
- STV for elected streams
- one-third retire every two years

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- six-year member term.
- ARTICLE 190 resignation needs voluntary/genuine acceptance; unauthorised sixty-day absence may vacate seat.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARTICLE 190 resignation needs voluntary/genuine acceptance; unauthorised sixty-day absence may vacate seat.**

## 03 STAGE 03 — SESSIONS, OFFICERS, QUORUM AND PARTICIPATION

SESSIONS, OFFICERS, QUORUM AND PARTICIPATION · ARTICLE 174 · GOVERNOR SUMMONS ON ADVICE · ASSEMBLY DISSOLUTION NO MORE THAN SIX MONTHS BETWEEN LAST · ASSEMBLY SPEAKER/DEPUTY SPEAKER · COUNCIL CHAIRMAN/DEPUTY CHAIRMAN REMOVAL · MAJORITY OF ALL THEN MEMBERS + FOURTEEN DAYS NOTICE. · SPEAKER SURVIVES DISSOLUTION UNTIL IMMEDIATELY BEFORE NEW ASSEMBLY'S FIRST

ARTICLE 174 → Governor summons on advice → sitting → adjournment → prorogation → Assembly dissolution no more → between last sitting and next session's first sitting. → Assembly Speaker/Deputy Speaker → Council Chairman/Deputy Chairman removal: majority of all then members + fourteen days notice.

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 174
- Governor summons on advice → sitting → adjournment → prorogation → Assembly dissolution no more than six months

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- between last sitting and next session's first sitting.
- Assembly Speaker/Deputy Speaker

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Council Chairman/Deputy Chairman removal: majority of all then members + fourteen days notice.
- Speaker survives dissolution until immediately before new Assembly's first meeting.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 189 DEFAULT until State law provides otherwise: ten or one-tenth, whichever greater.
- Ordinary vote: present and voting; chair has casting vote on equality.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ordinary vote: present and voting; chair has casting vote on equality.**

## 04 STAGE 04 — PRESIDING OFFICER NEUTRALITY AND ANTI-DEFECTION CONTROL

PRESIDING OFFICER NEUTRALITY AND ANTI-DEFECTION CONTROL · TENTH SCHEDULE PARTY EXIT/WHIP BREACH · INDEPENDENT JOINS · NOMINATED JOINS AFTER SIX MONTHS ONLY TWO-THIRDS MERGER DEFENCE · KIHOTO HOLLOHAN (1992) · SPEAKER IS TRIBUNAL; JUDICIAL REVIEW SURVIVES. · KEISHAM MEGHACHANDRA (2020) · ORDINARILY THREE-MONTH OUTER LIMIT ABSENT EXCEPTION.

TENTH SCHEDULE party exit/whip breach → independent joins → nominated joins after six months only two-thirds merger defence survives. → Kihoto Hollohan (1992) → Speaker is tribunal; judicial review survives. → Keisham Meghachandra (2020) → ordinarily three-month outer limit absent exception.

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- TENTH SCHEDULE party exit/whip breach
- independent joins
- nominated joins after six months only two-thirds merger defence survives.

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Kihoto Hollohan (1992) → Speaker is tribunal; judicial review survives.
- Keisham Meghachandra (2020) → ordinarily three-month outer limit absent exception.
- Padi Kaushik Reddy (2025) → Telangana petitions ordered concluded within three months.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Subhash Desai (2023) → political party, not faction, appoints authorised whip/leader.
- Nabam Rebia (2016) referred Speaker-removal issue remains unresolved.
- REFORM: reasoned orders, equal procedure and independent adjudication proposal.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Kihoto Hollohan (1992) → Speaker is tribunal; judicial review survives.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REFORM: reasoned orders, equal procedure and independent adjudication proposal.**

## 05 STAGE 05 — PRIVILEGES, ACCOUNTABILITY DEVICES AND REVIEW

PRIVILEGES, ACCOUNTABILITY DEVICES AND REVIEW · ARTICLE 194 SPEECH/VOTE IMMUNITY + AUTHORISED PUBLICATION PROTECTION · FUNCTIONAL LEGISLATIVE SHIELD. · SITA SOREN (2024) · BRIBERY IS NOT PROTECTED BY SPEECH/VOTE PRIVILEGE. · AMARINDER SINGH (2010) · PRIVILEGE IS NO GENERAL PUNISHMENT FOR UNRELATED PAST EXECUTIVE · RAJA RAM PAL (2007)

ARTICLE 194 speech/vote immunity + authorised publication protection → functional legislative shield. → Sita Soren (2024) → bribery is not protected by speech/vote privilege. → Amarinder Singh (2010) → privilege is no general punishment for unrelated past executive acts. → Raja Ram Pal (2007) → substantive illegality, mala fides and jurisdiction remain reviewable. → ACCOUNTABILITY questions → discussions → motions → budget scrutiny → committees → no-confidence.

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 194 speech/vote immunity + authorised publication protection → functional legislative shield.
- Sita Soren (2024) → bribery is not protected by speech/vote privilege.

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Amarinder Singh (2010) → privilege is no general punishment for unrelated past executive acts.
- Raja Ram Pal (2007) → substantive illegality, mala fides and jurisdiction remain reviewable.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- ACCOUNTABILITY questions → discussions → motions → budget scrutiny → committees → no-confidence.
- Only Assembly confidence can make or unmake the ministry.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- TRAP: Governor is a legislative component, not an Article 194-protected member.
- ARTICLE 194 speech/vote immunity + authorised publication protection → functional legislative shield.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Governor is a legislative component, not an Article 194-protected member.**

## 06 STAGE 06 — ORDINARY BILLS, LAPSE AND UNEQUAL BICAMERALISM

ORDINARY BILLS, LAPSE AND UNEQUAL BICAMERALISM · ASSEMBLY READINGS/COMMITTEE/VOTE · ARTICLE 200 ASSENT GATEWAY · BICAMERAL ASSEMBLY BILL · ASSEMBLY PASSES · COUNCIL DELAY UP TO 3 MONTHS · ASSEMBLY REPASSES · COUNCIL DELAY UP TO 1 MONTH

Assembly readings/committee/vote → Article 200 assent gateway. → BICAMERAL ASSEMBLY BILL → Assembly passes → Council delay up to 3 months → Assembly repasses → Council delay up to 1 month → Assembly form prevails; no State joint sitting. → COUNCIL-ORIGINATED BILL

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Assembly readings/committee/vote → Article 200 assent gateway.
- BICAMERAL ASSEMBLY BILL

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Assembly passes → Council delay up to 3 months → Assembly repasses
- Council delay up to 1 month → Assembly form prevails; no State joint sitting.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- COUNCIL-ORIGINATED BILL
- Council passes → Assembly rejects → Bill ends; no reciprocal Council override.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 196 LAPSE prorogation: no lapse
- pending only in Council: no lapse on Assembly dissolution pending in Assembly or passed Assembly/pending Council: lapses on dissolution.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARTICLE 196 LAPSE prorogation: no lapse | pending only in Council: no lapse on Assembly dissolution pending in Assembly or passed Assembly/pending Council: lapses on dissolution.**

## 07 STAGE 07 — MONEY BILLS AND ARTICLE 207 FINANCIAL CATEGORIES

MONEY BILLS AND ARTICLE 207 FINANCIAL CATEGORIES · MONEY BILL · ARTICLES 198-199 · GOVERNOR RECOMMENDATION · ASSEMBLY INTRODUCTION · SPEAKER CERTIFICATE · COUNCIL RECOMMENDATIONS WITHIN 14 DAYS · ASSEMBLY DECIDES

| CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE | POWER / PROCEDURE | CHECK / LIMIT | FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT |
|---|---|---|---|
| MONEY BILL: ARTICLES 198-199 | Council recommendations within 14 days → Assembly decides → Article 200. | ARTICLE 207(1) WIDER FINANCIAL BILL contains Article 199(1)(a)-(f) matter plus others → recommendation + Assembly origin | ARTICLE 207(3) EXPENDITURE BILL may originate in either House → cannot be passed without Governor recommendation for consideration |
| Governor recommendation → Assembly introduction → Speaker certificate | Council cannot reject, amend, vote grants or force joint sitting. | ordinary-Bill route after introduction. | → not automatically a Money Bill. |

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- MONEY BILL: ARTICLES 198-199
- Governor recommendation → Assembly introduction → Speaker certificate

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Council recommendations within 14 days → Assembly decides → Article 200.
- Council cannot reject, amend, vote grants or force joint sitting.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 207(1) WIDER FINANCIAL BILL contains Article 199(1)(a)-(f) matter plus others → recommendation + Assembly origin
- ordinary-Bill route after introduction.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 207(3) EXPENDITURE BILL may originate in either House → cannot be passed without Governor recommendation for consideration
- → not automatically a Money Bill.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARTICLE 207(3) EXPENDITURE BILL may originate in either House → cannot be passed without Governor recommendation for consideration → not automatically a Money Bill.**

## 08 STAGE 08 — BUDGET, FUNDS, COMMITTEES AND EXECUTIVE SCRUTINY

BUDGET, FUNDS, COMMITTEES AND EXECUTIVE SCRUTINY · ARTICLES 202-207 · ANNUAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT · CHARGED ITEMS DISCUSSED, NOT VOTED · DEMANDS FOR GRANTS VOTED ONLY BY ASSEMBLY · APPROPRIATION AUTHORISES WITHDRAWAL · FINANCE/FINANCIAL LEGISLATION COMPLETES REVENUE AUTHORITY. · COMMITTEE RAIL

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLES 202-207
- Annual Financial Statement → charged items discussed, not voted
- demands for grants voted only by Assembly → appropriation authorises withdrawal

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Finance/financial legislation completes revenue authority.
- COMMITTEE RAIL
- Public Accounts → audit and appropriation

### CHECK / LIMIT

- Estimates → economy and administrative improvement
- Public Undertakings → State enterprise scrutiny
- State-specific subject/Bill committees → evidence and clause-level examination.

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- EFFECTIVE CONTROL = time + data + research + tracked government response.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EFFECTIVE CONTROL = time + data + research + tracked government response.**

## 09 STAGE 09 — ARTICLES 200-201 ASSENT AND CURRENT LEGAL CONTROL

ARTICLES 200-201 ASSENT AND CURRENT LEGAL CONTROL · ARTICLE 200 ASSENT · RETURN NON-MONEY BILL ONCE · RESERVE FOR PRESIDENT MANDATORY RESERVATION WHERE HIGH COURT CONSTITUTIONAL · ARTICLE 201 · PRESIDENT MAY ASSENT, WITHHOLD OR DIRECT RETURN OF NON-MONEY · REPASSAGE DOES NOT COMPEL PRESIDENTIAL ASSENT. · STATE OF TAMIL NADU V. GOVERNOR OF TAMIL NADU (2025)

ARTICLE 200 assent → return non-Money Bill once → reserve for President mandatory reservation where High Court constitutional powers are endangered. → ARTICLE 201 → President may assent, withhold or direct return of non-Money Bill

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 200 assent
- return non-Money Bill once
- reserve for President mandatory reservation where High Court constitutional powers are endangered.

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARTICLE 201
- President may assent, withhold or direct return of non-Money Bill
- repassage does not compel presidential assent.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025)
- timelines and deemed assent used on the facts.
- In re Assent, Withholding or Reservation of Bills (2025)

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- advisory; no rigid timelines or automatic deemed assent
- prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. No technical overruling claim.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: prolonged unexplained inaction remains reviewable. No technical overruling claim.**

## 10 STAGE 10 — COUNCIL VERSUS ASSEMBLY AND RAJYA SABHA

COUNCIL VERSUS ASSEMBLY AND RAJYA SABHA · ASSEMBLY COUNCIL MANDATORY, DIRECT OPTIONAL, INDIRECT/NOMINATED MAY DISSOLVE PERMANENT · MONEY BILL CONTROL 14-DAY RECOMMENDATIONS · ARTICLE 169 INITIATION EXISTENCE DEPENDS ON ASSEMBLY ROUTE. · RAJYA SABHA CONTRAST MANDATORY FEDERAL HOUSE · BROADLY CO-EQUAL ORDINARY LAW · ARTICLES 249 AND 312 POWERS. · COUNCIL LEGITIMACY RESTS ON SCRUTINY, NOT FEDERAL REPRESENTATION OR

| CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE | POWER / PROCEDURE | CHECK / LIMIT | FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT |
|---|---|---|---|
| ASSEMBLY COUNCIL mandatory, direct optional, indirect/nominated may dissolve permanent confidence + grants questions/debate, no confidence control final ordinary-Bill | Money Bill control 14-day recommendations | RAJYA SABHA CONTRAST mandatory federal House | Articles 249 and 312 powers. |
| will maximum 3+1 month delay | Article 169 initiation existence depends on Assembly route. | broadly co-equal ordinary law | Council legitimacy rests on scrutiny, not federal representation or final veto. |

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ASSEMBLY COUNCIL mandatory, direct optional, indirect/nominated may dissolve permanent confidence + grants questions/debate, no confidence control final ordinary-Bill
- will maximum 3+1 month delay

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- Money Bill control 14-day recommendations
- Article 169 initiation existence depends on Assembly route.

### CHECK / LIMIT

- RAJYA SABHA CONTRAST mandatory federal House
- broadly co-equal ordinary law

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Articles 249 and 312 powers.
- Council legitimacy rests on scrutiny, not federal representation or final veto.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Council legitimacy rests on scrutiny, not federal representation or final veto.**

## 11 STAGE 11 — CURRENT REPRESENTATION CONTROLS AND EXAM SYNTHESIS

CURRENT REPRESENTATION CONTROLS AND EXAM SYNTHESIS · CURRENT AT 28 AUGUST 2026 SIX COUNCIL STATES · 106TH AMENDMENT RESERVATION NOT OPERATIONAL · CENSUS REFERENCE · 1 MAR 2027 GENERALLY; 1 OCT 2026 IN SPECIFIED · 2026 DELIMITATION-LINKED BILLS FAILED/WITHDRAWN AND ARE NOT LAW. · REFORM ROUTE PREDICTABLE SITTINGS · PRIOR BILL PUBLICATION

CURRENT AT 28 AUGUST 2026 six Council States → 106th Amendment reservation not operational → Census reference: 1 Mar 2027 generally; 1 Oct 2026 in specified snow-bound areas → 2026 delimitation-linked Bills failed/withdrawn and are not law. → REFORM ROUTE predictable sittings

### CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CURRENT AT 28 AUGUST 2026 six Council States
- 106th Amendment reservation not operational
- Census reference: 1 Mar 2027 generally; 1 Oct 2026 in specified snow-bound areas
- 2026 delimitation-linked Bills failed/withdrawn and are not law.

### POWER / PROCEDURE

- REFORM ROUTE predictable sittings
- prior Bill publication
- stronger committees non-partisan research
- timely Speaker decisions

### CHECK / LIMIT

- transparent nominations public assent tracker
- modernised Council representation.
- MAINS SPINE
- Article/design → mechanism → Assembly-Council comparison → case/current evidence

### FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- democratic or scrutiny consequence → targeted reform → representative-federal verdict.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: democratic or scrutiny consequence → targeted reform → representative-federal verdict.**

## E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT) · 28. WHY OPTIONAL BICAMERALISM DIFFERS FROM FEDERAL BICAMERALISM · 29. THE DEMOCRATIC CASE AGAINST OCCUPATIONAL CONSTITUENCIES · 30. PRESIDING OFFICER REFORM OPTIONS · 31. MODEL ANSWER-WRITING METHOD · [ANALYSIS] RAJYA SABHA IS BUILT INTO THE UNION'S FEDERAL · [ANALYSIS] COUNCIL ELECTORATES ARE FUNCTIONALLY HETEROGENEOUS RATHER THAN STATE-REPRESENTATIVE. · [ANALYSIS] ITS WEAKNESS ON ORDINARY BILLS MEANS BICAMERALISM SUPPLIES

### OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- 28. Why optional bicameralism differs from federal bicameralism
- 29. The democratic case against occupational constituencies
- 30. Presiding officer reform options
- 31. Model answer-writing method

### ADVANCED LIMIT

- [ANALYSIS] Rajya Sabha is built into the Union's federal architecture; a Council is created only when a State and Parliament choose it.
- [ANALYSIS] Council electorates are functionally heterogeneous rather than State-representative.
- [ANALYSIS] Its weakness on ordinary Bills means bicameralism supplies delay without final bargaining equality.
- [LIMIT] Weakness does not equal uselessness. Even delay may expose drafting flaws, enable public debate or force compromise.

### COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- [ANALYSIS] Graduate and teacher constituencies were designed to draw specialised voices into legislation.
- [ANALYSIS] Expansion of higher education weakens the historical claim that graduates form a small expert class.
- [ANALYSIS] Unequal functional franchise can appear inconsistent with universal political equality even while constitutionally valid.
- [ANALYSIS] Reform options include updating eligibility, widening professional representation, strengthening local-body representation or redesigning nomination.

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.